



"The New Nuclear Future",
October 20, 2008

**"India's legitimacy
as a responsible
nuclear power has been
endorsed, despite it
being a non-signatory
to the CTBT and NPT."**

S. LAKSHMI RAGHURAM,
on e-mail

It's a Deal, Finally

Aroon Purie and his dedicated, persistent band of Indo-US nuclear deal warriors should take a bow ("The New Nuclear Future", October 20). Purie has set the pace with his hard-hitting editorial followed by a brilliant cover story by Raj Chengappa. Chengappa is prescient in pointing out potential downsides, especially in terms of safety of reactor operations. However, the issue of overall security of our nuclear assets is equally germane and we must learn from the recent nuclear security lapses in the US to avoid such situations here in India in future. **MAJOR GENERAL (retd) RAJ MEHTA, Mohali**

Euphoric jubilation over the Indo-US nuclear deal is absolutely justified. It had become mandatory—because of the failure of the

power sector, one of the essential components of the infrastructure of the nation—to meet the growing demand of electricity, an incontrovertible prerequisite for development as well as for employment generation. Now it is the responsibility of nuclear scientists and policymakers to incorporate it ingeniously and with sagacity to protect the country from its negative side-effects and make this achievement truly historic.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

Raj Chengappa deserves to be congratulated on his enlightening and informative article. It deals with a variety of aspects of India's nuclear future in an effective manner. In addition to the generation of much-needed power, the nuclear industry could change the very complexion of India's development if only it takes this challenge as an opportu-

nity and makes a serious effort to develop a comprehensive plan to build supporting infrastructure that includes component industries, transportation, housing developments, schools and colleges, and creates awareness regarding nuclear power and the responsibilities that come with it.

GIRI GIRISHANKAR, on e-mail

Now that India is in a position to conduct civilian nuclear trade with the world, advancement of nuclear weaponry is and should not be its prime concern. The day is now not far when India completely solves its electricity problems with the succour of nuclear technology, a feat that will go a long way in India's development.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, on e-mail

Devil's Workshop

It is shocking to hear young and educated men like Shakeel, Nisar and

Rehman so blithely talking about killing innocent people in the name of jihad for Allah, without a glint of remorse ("Inside the Mind of the Bombers", October 13). They claim they feel unwelcome and are indifferently treated which makes them and others from their community resort to extreme measures. But their way of avenging this prejudice against them and the Muslim community doesn't justify their means—killing people in the name of Allah. It is disgraceful and an unforgivable crime against humanity.

NIKHAR BHATIA, on e-mail

It's really unfortunate that the jihadis sacrifice their lives in the name of Allah for the welfare of fellow beings ("Silence of the Lambs", October 13). These jihadis are lunatics who lure, incite and poison the vulnerable minds of the youth with their teachings and leave them to wreak